BRANDON LOVE

CYBERSECURITY ANALYST | SOC • INCIDENT RESPONSE • DETECTION ENGINEERING

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Military professional and U.S. Army Staff Sergeant transitioning into cybersecurity, bringing 12+ years of leadership, risk assessment, and disciplined operational decision-making. Builds hands-on SOC labs, investigates SIEM alerts, correlates authentication and endpoint activity, and documents evidence-based findings. Experience with Wazuh, Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender, KQL, Python, and Linux; seeking a cybersecurity analyst role focused on detection, investigation, and response.

CORE SKILLS

SOC Operations: Alert triage • Incident investigation • Threat hunting • Incident response • Detection engineering • Log analysis • Vulnerability management • Technical reporting

Platforms & Tools: Microsoft Sentinel • Microsoft Defender • Wazuh • Log Analytics • KQL • Sysmon • Wireshark/TShark • VirusTotal • GitHub Actions

Technical: Windows • Linux • TCP/IP • DNS • PCAP/EVTX analysis • Python • PowerShell • Git • MITRE ATT&CK • NIST incident-response concepts

CYBERSECURITY PROJECTS — HANDS-ON LABS

AI-Assisted Cloud SOC & Incident Response Lab | *Google Cloud • Wazuh • Tailscale • Python • SQLite*

- Connected a Google Cloud Ubuntu endpoint to Wazuh over Tailscale; built a Python/FastAPI integration that persists raw alerts and incident timelines in SQLite and delivers THOTH-assisted triage to Telegram.
- Validated authentication, sudo, account creation/deletion, and file-activity detections through controlled exercises; reviewed a 41-event incident timeline and separated observed evidence from investigative hypotheses.
- Implemented persistent incident IDs, four lifecycle states, 15-minute correlation, and a 60-second quiet period; identified cross-host correlation limitations and retained human approval for remediation.

Security Tools Engineering Portfolio | *Python • Pytest • GitHub Actions • TShark*

- Developed and hardened three defensive analyst tools for PCAP profiling, Windows event-log triage, and safe JavaScript unpacking; treated recovered data as attacker-controlled input.
- Added 79 automated tests, 91% core coverage for Eval Unpacker, clean-wheel installation checks, dependency auditing, secret scanning, and multi-version CI across Python 3.9–3.13.
- Corrected analytical accuracy, secured HTML reporting, bounded hostile-input processing, and documented evidence provenance through reviewable GitHub pull requests.

Microsoft Sentinel / Defender Detection & Response Lab | *Azure • KQL • Log Analytics • Logic Apps*

- Configured Azure log ingestion and KQL analytics to investigate security activity and detect suspicious Network Security Group rule changes.
- Generated controlled incidents and tested a Logic Apps playbook; documented triage context, query logic, and validation evidence.

ADDITIONAL SOC & SECURITY LABS

Wazuh SIEM Lab | *Windows/Linux endpoints • VirusTotal • Action1*

- Deployed and managed Wazuh for endpoint monitoring, centralized log analysis, file-integrity monitoring, vulnerability detection, and security-event investigation.
- Generated controlled security activity to validate alert coverage, investigate telemetry, and rehearse SIEM triage workflows.
- Integrated VirusTotal enrichment and Action1 patch management into a detect, enrich, remediate, and validate workflow.

Wireless Security Assessment Platform | *ESP32 • Wi-Fi • Bluetooth/BLE • NFC • IoT*

- Configured and tested an ESP32-based platform for authorized Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, NFC, and IoT security assessments.
- Conducted wireless reconnaissance, BLE device analysis, service enumeration, and network discovery in controlled environments.
- Logged and analyzed wireless security data to support assessment findings and technical reporting.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

U.S. Army Reserve — Staff Sergeant / Motor Transport Operator | *Jan 2013–Present | Bryan, TX*

- Lead and train teams of up to 12 personnel during time-sensitive operations, prioritizing risk, accountability, communication, and mission continuity.
- Coordinate secure movement of sensitive equipment and maintain chain-of-custody, inspection, and operational records in policy-controlled environments.
- Conduct risk assessments, develop mitigation plans, and reinforce OPSEC, access-control awareness, and incident-reporting procedures.

AKIMA LLC — Heavy Truck Driver | *May 2021–Present | Fort Hood, TX*

- Manage transport of sensitive ammunition and equipment while maintaining accurate documentation, chain-of-custody integrity, and regulatory compliance.
- Perform daily asset verification and coordinate with cross-functional teams to resolve discrepancies and sustain operational readiness.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

Purdue University Global — B.S. Cybersecurity | *2024–Present | GPA: 4.0*

Certification: ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) • SOC Analyst Learning Path, LetsDefend (completed 2025)

Additional: Secret security clearance • 20+ simulated SOC incidents investigated and documented